

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-III.1: The Independent Reader Workflow

Map an unfamiliar passage, propose lemmas before lookup, and move from analytical reconstruction to direct sense

Stage	Stage III — Independent Missal Reading
Prerequisite	EL-II.14 mastery and passage of EL-GATE-II (C-A and delayed C-B)
Next	EL-III.2, The Ordinary and the Fixed Order

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

The Independent Missal Reader

On completing this unit, you can:

- define a testable meaning of “without a facing translation”;
- read a Missal passage in grammatical passes instead of guessing from memory;
- reconstruct prose order without erasing emphasis;
- use a dictionary only after morphology and clause structure have narrowed the question.

For this volume, a **complete Mass** means the fixed prayer text of the *Ordo Missæ* and Roman Canon together with every prayer, lesson, Gospel, and chant text assigned to a particular formulary. It does not mean memorizing rubrics, reading musical notation, or translating the priest’s optional prayers before and after Mass. The *Kyrie* is Greek; Hebrew or Greek liturgical words such as *Amen*, *Alleluia*, and *Hosanna* remain part of the corpus but are not evidence about Latin grammar.

Independent-reading definitions

A **genre** is a recurring class of text identified by its liturgical job and its usual formal features: a Collect and a Gospel may concern the same feast, but they remain different genres because one petitions and the other proclaims a reading. A **formulary** is the set of texts assigned together for one Mass; it can therefore contain several genres.

A **lemma** is the dictionary headword under which an inflected form is listed.

A **head** is the central word that a phrase expands. A **governor** is a word or construction that licenses another element, often demanding a case or nonfinite form. A **complement** completes the sense or construction of its governor.

To **construe** a passage is to account for these forms and dependencies so that its sense follows from the Latin. A **prose-order reconstruction** is a temporary diagnostic rearrangement that places dependencies together; it is neither a correction of the source nor a translation.

1.1 What “no facing translation” does and does not mean

It does not forbid English during instruction. A precise translation can expose a false parse. It does forbid using a parallel English column as a substitute for reading during a gate. At a no-facing-translation gate the Latin page is alone. The learner demonstrates understanding by marking clauses, identifying forms, answering short Latin questions, giving a restrained written sense, and explaining the relation of each subordinate clause to its governor.

Familiarity is not the same as sight reading. Accordingly, every final gate has two parts: a familiar text read fluently and an unseen text of the same genre. **Unseen** means not used in the teaching volume or assigned worksheet, although its grammar and high-frequency vocabulary may be familiar.

Three passes through an unfamiliar passage

Pass 1—frame. Circle coordinators and subordinators; underline every finite verb; bracket vocatives and parenthetical *quæsumus*; draw a line after each independent clause. Do not use a dictionary.

Pass 2—dependencies. Mark subjects, direct objects, governed cases, infinitives, participles, and antecedents. Supply an omitted form only in square brackets. Write the supplied Latin, not an English guess.

Pass 3—sense. Read again in the printed order. Consult a dictionary only for a word whose lemma and syntactic slot have already been proposed. Revise the clause map when the proposed meaning does not fit the construction.

1.2 Reconstruction without flattening

Missal word order is meaningful even when it is not the order most convenient for first analysis. Make a disposable prose-order line beneath the text:

1. write the finite verb and its explicit or implicit subject;
2. attach complements demanded by that verb;
3. place modifiers beside their heads;
4. expand subordinate clauses from the outside inward;
5. return to the printed order and state what the displacement emphasizes.

Consider the controlled drill *Tibi, Domine, sacrificium laudis offerimus*, built from recurrent Missal offering diction but not presented as a quotation. Analytical order is *nos offerimus sacrificium laudis tibi, Domine*. The initial *tibi* is not disorder: it foregrounds the recipient. Reconstruction is a scaffold, not a rewritten liturgical text.

1.3 Dictionary discipline

Never look up an inflected form as though it were a lemma. Before opening a dictionary, write four things: proposed lemma, morphology, syntactic function, and a provisional semantic class. For *perfruamur*, for example, write *perfruor, perfrui, perfructus sum; first plural present subjunctive, deponent; verb of the ut-clause; enjoyment/possession; governs ablative*.

During unit work, allow at most five new content-word lookups per one hundred words on the first assisted reading. Function words, endings, and words already entered in the vocabulary ledger do not earn repeat lookups. Record a family, not an orphan: *redimo, redemptio, redemptor; offero, oblatio, munus; salvus, salvo, salus, salutaris*.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 What “no facing translation” does and does not mean — transfer practice

Connection. Direct reading is visible analysis before summary, not a ban on English during correction.

Transfer task. Using the first selected worksheet passage, make a no-aid frame map, then write a two-sentence sense only after every finite form and subject is accounted for.

Retrieval check. List three kinds of evidence that distinguish a parse from remembered translation.

1.2 Reconstruction without flattening — transfer practice

Connection. A disposable analytical line must lead back to an observation about the source’s printed order.

Transfer task. Reconstruct the lesson’s project-composed *Tibi, Domine, sacrificium laudis offerimus*; then state what initial *tibi* foregrounds.

Retrieval check. Name one element that reconstruction may move and one that it may never invent.

1.3 Dictionary discipline — transfer practice

Connection. A strong lookup begins with a falsifiable grammatical proposal.

Transfer task. For the lesson’s *perfruamur*, write the four-line pre-lookup hypothesis, check it, and record whether the lexicon changed lemma, construction, or only sense.

Retrieval check. State the condition under which a second lookup of the same content word counts against the ceiling.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit III.1: Reading Method and Dictionary Discipline

The four variants under each unit are interchangeable. Complete any two before the unit gate; use the others for remediation or delayed retrieval. Unless a prompt explicitly permits a dictionary, make a complete first-pass clause map before consulting one. All cited liturgical text is from the *Missale Romanum* (1962).

Worksheet III.1 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.1

Focus: Clause frames before vocabulary

Use: Map first; no dictionary for Items 1–5.

1. In *Dominus vobiscum*, state the conventional optative construal and identify *vobiscum*.
 2. In the controlled word-order drill, underline the finite verb and attach every dependent in *Tibi, Domine, sacrificium laudis offerimus*.
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3. Reconstruct *Puris mereamur mentibus introire* in analytical order, then state what may not be omitted.
-
4. Classify the supply in *lex Dei eius in corde ipsius [est]* as grammatical, parallel, or interpretive and justify it.
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5. Explain why capital letters cannot decide the syntax of *Salvatorem germinet terra*.
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6. **Text:** *Vias tuas, Domine, notas fac mihi: et semitas tuas edoce me.*
Passage ID: III.1.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Make a clause map, prose-order line, and literal sense; no dictionary.
-

Worksheet III.4 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** III.4**Focus:** Cold-read gate rehearsal**Use:** No lookup until the final item.

1. **Text:** *Largire nobis, quæsumus, Domine, semper spiritum cogitandi quæ recta sunt, propitius et agendi: ut, qui sine te esse non possumus, secundum te vivere valeamus.*

Passage ID: III.4.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Mark every clause, nonfinite form, and antecedent.

-
2. Write the minimum prose-order reconstruction of the passage.

-
3. In simple Latin answer: *Quid Dominus largiri rogatur?*

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4. In simple Latin answer: *Cur auxilio Domini egemus?*

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5. State the function of *propitius*; give one defensible English sense without rearranging it into a separate clause.

-
6. Now permit two lookups. Which entries, if any, materially improve the parse rather than merely polish English?
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Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: On a fresh 120–180-word passage, mark at least 90% of finite clauses and sampled forms, justify every supply, and consult a dictionary only after recording lemma, morphology, function, and a provisional semantic class.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-III.2, The Ordinary and the Fixed Order.

If it is not met: Worksheets III.2 and III.3 remain optional lookup-control and reconstruction remediation.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

What “no facing translation” does and does not mean — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A complete model marks coordinators, finite verbs, subjects, governed forms, and any bracketed supply before giving sense. Accept morphology, clause attachment, and reference as the three evidence kinds; familiarity alone is not evidence.

Reconstruction without flattening — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Model: *Nos offerimus sacrificium laudis tibi, Domine.* The reconstruction groups verb, subject, object, genitive, and recipient; the return pass notes the foregrounded recipient. Words may move, but absent content may not be invented.

Dictionary discipline — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model proposes *perfruor*; first plural present subjunctive deponent; verbal center of its clause; enjoyment/possession governing an ablative. A repeated ledger word counts again when the learner failed to retain or recognize it.

CHAPTER 2

Unit III.1: Reading Method and Dictionary Discipline

Solution III.1 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.1

Focus: Clause frames before vocabulary

Use: Map first; no dictionary for Items 1–5.

1. In *Dominus vobiscum*, state the conventional optative construal and identify *vobiscum*.
Answer / model: An interpretive pedagogical paraphrase is *[sit] Dominus vobiscum*; *sit* is not expressed or uniquely forced by morphology. *vobiscum* is *cum* with ablative second-person plural pronoun; the phrase is comitative. Supplying *est* would not preserve the conventional optative force.
2. In the controlled word-order drill, underline the finite verb and attach every dependent in *Tibi, Domine, sacrificium laudis offerimus*.
Answer / model: Finite verb: *offerimus*; implicit subject *nos*; object *sacrificium*; dependent genitive *laudis*; recipient *tibi*; vocative *Domine*.
3. Reconstruct *Puris mereamur mentibus introire* in analytical order, then state what may not be omitted.
Answer / model: Analytical order: *mereamur introire puris mentibus*. *mereamur* is first plural present subjunctive deponent and requires complementary infinitive *introire*; *puris mentibus* is ablative of attendant manner.
4. Classify the supply in *lex Dei eius in corde ipsius [est]* as grammatical, parallel, or interpretive and justify it.
Answer / model: I: the printed text is a verbless nominal clause with a prepositional location predicate. *[est]* is an interpretive dependency or English paraphrase; Latin does not require an overt copula, and no additional content word may be supplied.
5. Explain why capital letters cannot decide the syntax of *Salvatorem germinet terra*.
Answer / model: Case endings decide it: nominative *terra* is subject; accusative *Salvatorem* object; third-person singular subjunctive *germinet* agrees with *terra*. Capitals are editorial/devotional.
6. **Text:** *Vias tuas, Domine, notas fac mihi: et semitas tuas edoce me.*
Passage ID: III.1.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
 Make a clause map, prose-order line, and literal sense; no dictionary.
Answer / notes: Two coordinated imperatives: *fac* and *edoce*, implicit divine subject. Prose order: *Domine, fac vias tuas notas mihi et edoce me semitas tuas*. *notas* is predicate accusative; *mihi* dative; *me* object. Sense: make your ways known to me and teach me your paths.

Solution III.4 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.4

Focus: Cold-read gate rehearsal

Use: No lookup until the final item.

1. **Text:** *Largire nobis, quæsumus, Domine, semper spiritum cogitandi quæ recta sunt, propitius et agendi: ut, qui sine te esse non possumus, secundum te vivere valeamus.*
Passage ID: III.4.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
 Mark every clause, nonfinite form, and antecedent.
Answer / notes: Main petition *largire* with recipient *nobis* and object *spiritum*; genitive gerunds *cogitandi* ... *et agendi* depend on *spiritum*; *quæ recta sunt* is a substantival relative, object of both gerunds by sense. Result/purpose *ut* ... *valeamus*; embedded substantival *qui* has antecedent implicit *nos*; infinitives *esse* and *vivere* complement *possumus/valeamus*.
2. Write the minimum prose-order reconstruction of the passage.
Answer / model: *Domine, propitius largire nobis semper spiritum cogitandi et agendi quæ recta sunt, ut nos, qui sine te esse non possumus, valeamus secundum te vivere.*
3. In simple Latin answer: *Quid Dominus largiri rogatur?*
Answer / model: *Rogatur ut nobis spiritum recta cogitandi et agendi largiatur.*
4. In simple Latin answer: *Cur auxilio Domini egemus?*
Answer / model: *Auxilio eius egemus quia sine eo esse non possumus.*
5. State the function of *propitius*; give one defensible English sense without rearranging it into a separate clause.
Answer / model: Predicate adjective with the implicit subject of *largire*, used with adverbial force: “being gracious/graciously grant.” It is not an adverbial form morphologically.
6. Now permit two lookups. Which entries, if any, materially improve the parse rather than merely polish English?
Answer / model: A prepared reader needs none. If needed, *largior*, *largiri*, *largitus sum* confirms a deponent imperative, and *secundum* confirms accusative *te*. Looking up *recta* before recognizing substantival neuter plural would not be disciplined.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-III.1, *The Independent Reader Workflow*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet establishes the independent-reading process; it does not by itself demonstrate sustained reading of a complete formulary.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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